What Did Release Release?

Service, Surety, and Conditional Freedoms in England, 1349-1358

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Abstract

Freedom in post-plague England cannot be reconstructed by treating exemption, departure, and release as interchangeable events. This article examines the Ordinance of Labourers (1349), the Statute of Labourers (1351), a Derbyshire commission (1356), and a Cornwall proceeding (1358). It argues that these documents allocated freedoms by the object and moment of an intervention: exemption from recruitment, justification of departure, protection of customary seasonal movement, release upon a commitment to serve, and discharge from a particular accusation. The 1356 commission makes the authority and fiscal destination of release consequential; the Cornwall proceeding separates initial attachment, subsequent custody, and eventual acquittal. A register of twenty-two source units supports close reading and an executable, deliberately partial reconstruction. Exhaustive checks show where collapsing distinct exceptions changes the reconstruction, while preserving unresolved predicates such as reasonable cause and customary eligibility. These results establish consequences of an explicit reading, not the frequency or effectiveness of medieval enforcement. The contribution is a source-linked account of how the removal of one constraint could coexist with another, together with a reproducible method for representing that coexistence without converting documentary silence into general freedom.

Keywords: medieval England; labour legislation; freedom; surety; legal history; computational history

1. The object of a freedom

In the Cornwall proceeding printed by Bertha Haven Putnam, four people pass from accusation through nonappearance and arrest to acquittal. The concluding direction permits them to depart quit. In the Ordinance of Labourers, by contrast, detention for refusal of service has a different stated endpoint: finding surety to serve. Both passages concern a person leaving custody. Yet the legal work done by that departure differs. One disposes of a presented accusation; the other secures future service. A history that records only a transition from detained to released would preserve the physical contrast while losing the distinction that made release legally intelligible (Putnam 1908, Appendix, pp. 152-154; White and Notestein 1915, pp. 141-142, 156-157).

This article asks what must be specified before an act can count as making a freedom. Its answer is relational and temporal: an account must identify the constraint removed, the relation affected, the authority involved, and the obligation, if any, preserved. Applied to English labour legislation after the Black Death, this approach brings recruitment, departure, movement, and release into one analysis without making them

equivalent. The argument is that particular openings were distributed across different stages of an employment and enforcement relationship. Leaving one stage did not necessarily remove the constraints attached to another.

The distinction matters for histories of the makings and transformations of freedom. A statutory qualification can matter without being an emancipation. A court's discharge can matter without conferring a general employment privilege. Conversely, a person's continuing exposure to wage regulation does not make a successful defence or permitted departure historically meaningless. Studying these differences offers a way to describe freedoms within coercive relations without either dissolving the coercion or rendering all particular freedoms analytically invisible.

The evidence is a bounded documentary sequence, not a newly discovered archive: two foundational normative texts, a commission addressing their enforcement, and one edited court proceeding. The contribution lies in reading their distinct release mechanisms together and making the interpretive consequences inspectable. The accompanying software does not discover a medieval theory of freedom or estimate how many workers enjoyed it. It checks whether a reconstruction preserves the distinctions on which its historical claims depend.

2. Scholarship and the remaining question

The coexistence of wage labour and coercion is established scholarship. Bennett's study of compulsory service makes the long history of compulsion central to the interpretation of late medieval employment regulation. Whittle explicitly distinguishes the development of wage labour from acceptance of personal choice in a free labour market. Her account follows the classification of workers, compulsory service, contractual restrictions, and the regulation of movement across the medieval and early modern divide (Bennett 2010; Whittle 2023, pp. 33-36, 43-53). It would therefore be misleading to present either paid compulsion or the restrictions on formally free workers as a discovery of this article.

Nor can an English statutory provision be treated as a transparent response to a universal demographic mechanism. Cohn's comparative account challenges a simple derivation of post-plague legislation from labour supply and demand. The political and moral framing of workers' conduct matters alongside economic disruption (Cohn 2007). Within England, Bailey questions the extent to which the 1349-1351 legislation merely codified existing rural regulation. His subsequent investigation separates public presentments from private litigation and records absences as well as instances of enforcement (Bailey 2023; 2025). Together these studies warn against moving directly from a legislative command to a uniform social practice.

The present question is narrower than whether labour was free or whether the statutes succeeded. It concerns the relation between particular qualifications and the other constraints that surrounded them. Whittle already identifies the protected movement of harvest workers and the importance of alternative terms to annual service. Bailey already explains that post-plague contract remedies could give employees grounds for defending departure, including an employer's failure to perform agreed obligations

(Whittle 2023, pp. 43-45, 52; Bailey 2025, p. 543). The argument here depends on these findings rather than claiming them as new.

What a combined reading adds is an account of the different objects of release. Exclusion from a recruitment clause, an excuse for departure during a term, a saving for seasonal migration, release after a service commitment, and acquittal of a presented charge are separate operations. Their coexistence can be specified more exactly than a single continuum from bondage to freedom permits. This specification also identifies a problem for digital editions and computational research: a representation that stores only an overall status can silently transfer an exception from one legal action to another.

The historical claim is thus interpretive, supported by close reading of published primary documents. The methodological claim is that an executable reconstruction can expose such transfers and document the decisions necessary to avoid them. Neither claim entails that previous historians have uniformly made the errors tested below. The deliberately simplified readings in the sensitivity analysis are analytic counterexamples, not a scored sample of the literature.

3. Documents, editions, and method

The core corpus consists of the Ordinance of Labourers of 18 June 1349; the Statute of Labourers of 1351; the commission to Robert Fraunceys and Thomas Adam of Ashbourne concerning Derbyshire, dated 10 March 1356; and the Cornwall proceeding of 1358 involving John Clegh junior, Nichola Karn, Dionisia Trethak, Thomas Tremenhir, and other defendants. English passages are taken from White and Notestein's Source Problems in English History, pp. 141-157. For the commission and Cornwall proceeding, the corresponding Latin texts in Putnam's documentary appendix were also consulted: pp. 24-25 and 152-154 respectively. The volume's internal dates and printed page numbers, rather than a website title, identify each document.

These are mediated witnesses. White and Notestein reproduce translations and abridge material for a teaching collection. Their note at p. 152 expressly acknowledges the omission of the statute's remaining directions. Putnam also uses ellipses and summarizes lists of names. The present analysis does not supply a diplomatic edition, reconstruct a complete roll, or claim to have inspected the underlying manuscripts. The repository preserves the downloaded OCR of both historical editions, their checksums, source URLs, retrieval date, and a register of twenty-two manually selected units. OCR anchors locate the passages; they are not a substitute for the printed text or for manuscript collation.

Selection follows the research question: units qualify recruitment, departure, movement, detention, disposition, or authority, or show a neighbouring constraint that an exception might wrongly be assumed to remove. Nine units concern the ordinance, six the statute, two the commission, and five the Cornwall proceeding. This is an interpretive register, not a random sample. Its unit count measures documentation in this study, not the incidence of freedoms in medieval England. Each unit records the legal action, edition locator, searchable anchor, evidence type, and interpretation. Appendix A supplies the complete compact register.

The analysis proceeds in three steps. First, close reading identifies the grammatical object of each condition or exception. Second, the reconstruction encodes a small selection of these relations, leaving evaluative terms as inputs rather than inventing criteria for them. Third, exhaustive enumeration and counterexamples identify what changes when a condition is omitted or transferred. The code therefore begins after substantial interpretation. Passing its tests demonstrates that the implementation follows the stated reconstruction; it cannot independently validate that reconstruction as the only historical reading.

The distinction between a provision not prohibiting an act and the legal order positively authorizing it is maintained throughout. A missing predicate is also distinct from a false predicate. Where customary eligibility or reasonable cause is unresolved, the model can return an unresolved result. This is particularly important because the sources often identify a relevant criterion without telling us exactly how it was assessed in a disputed case.

Table 1. Documentary distinctions retained in the reconstruction. Unit IDs refer to Appendix A.

Units	Object	Qualification or act	Boundary
O1-O3, 1349	Recruitment and priority	Trade, craft, resources, land, existing service; bounded lordly preference	No blanket exclusion from other provisions
O4-O5, 1349	Departure / receiving	Reasonable cause OR licence; agreed term	No automatic right to any new wage
S3-S5, 1351	Seasonal movement	Local service at prescribed terms; customary August movement and return	No express general cancellation of an existing term
O3 / S6	Custodial endpoint	Surety for service / compliance	Service obligation remains
D1-D2, 1356	Official release	Authority, statutory observance, destination of receipts	An inquiry directive, not proof of conviction
C1-C5, 1358	Presented accusation	Jury acquittal and discharge	No recorded general employment exemption

4. Before service: exemption and bounded priority

The opening command of 1349 includes men and women, free and bond. Its reach nevertheless depends on several conditions: bodily ability, age, livelihood, craft, resources, land occupation, existing service, and a suitable demand considered in relation to the person's estate. The text does not simply command every survivor to work for any requester. It constructs a class of people who can be required to enter a particular service relationship (White and Notestein 1915, pp. 141-142; units O1-O3).

Two conclusions follow, neither equivalent to the abolition of distinctions of status. First, formally free status does not by itself defeat the recruitment command. Second, failure of a recruitment condition does not establish that the person is beyond labour regulation. An artisan excluded by the reference to practising a craft encounters a later

clause regulating what artificers and workmen may take for their work. This juxtaposition is decisive: exemption has an object. Here it concerns the initial compulsory-service command, while a distinct wage constraint remains available in the same ordinance (pp. 143-144; O7).

Existing service produces a similar asymmetry. A person serving someone else falls outside the opening recruitment description, but the next clause addresses departure before an agreed term has ended. The very relation that blocks a new demand can supply the setting for a restriction on leaving. Describing this person as simply exempt or simply unfree misses how the rules distribute claims among employers and workers over time.

The proviso favouring lords in retaining their bondmen and land tenants is also bounded. It permits priority while limiting retention to what is necessary for the lords. Read as a restriction on competing employers, the preference is intelligible as an allocation of access to labour. Read with its qualification, it is not an unlimited power to reserve all one's tenants. The document supplies no numerical test of necessity and no worked example of surplus retention. It therefore supports an argument about the stated limit of a preference, rather than a measurement of how effectively that limit protected workers or other employers (p. 142; O2).

This distinction gives scarcity a specific legal shape. Need appears as a reason to compel labour, but also as a limit to a preferred claimant's retention. The ordinance was not merely identifying who lacked freedom. It was arranging whose claim to another person's service would be considered, under which conditions, and against which competing claim. The political advantage of employers remains evident, but employers are not made interchangeable by that advantage.

The ordinance's alms clause extends the same project beyond a bilateral employment relationship. It addresses support given to those represented as able to labour, seeking to make labour necessary for subsistence. The episcopal letter, in turn, addresses stipendiary chaplains through suspension and interdict. These provisions prevent the reconstruction from treating the opening recruitment clause as an exhaustive description of the law's coercive reach (pp. 145-146; O8-O9). They also show why an identical output labelled bound would conceal differences in institutions, sanctions, and routes of enforcement.

5. During service: departure, movement, and return

The ordinance's departure clause applies to a retained worker or servant leaving before the agreed term without reasonable cause or licence. Cause and licence are alternatives in the translated formulation. Omitting reasonable cause converts the clause into an exclusive power of permission; requiring both cause and licence narrows the qualification further. Neither alteration is supported by the wording used here (White and Notestein 1915, p. 142; O4).

This does not establish how readily a worker could secure recognition of a cause. The clause does not supply a catalogue, a burden of proof, or a decision procedure. Later evidence discussed by Whittle and Bailey shows why those questions matter, but it

cannot be projected indiscriminately onto every dispute in 1349-1358. In this reconstruction, cause means a cause accepted for purposes of the provision, not merely a worker's assertion and not a classification generated by software. A disputed cause remains unresolved.

The adjacent penalty on receiving or retaining such a departing worker matters as well. The text regulates the possibility of making a new employment relation after leaving an old one. An analysis of departure alone would miss the way this neighbouring provision could constrain the receiving employer. A valid exit from one relation and a viable new engagement are historically connected, but the law addresses them through distinct acts (p. 142; O5).

The 1351 statute adds a spatial and seasonal relation. The relevant servants are not to leave the town of winter residence to serve elsewhere in summer if service at the prescribed terms can be found in that town. It then saves the August movement and safe return of people from specified regions and other places, as previously accustomed. The restriction thus turns on local service, while the saving turns on time, origin or customary eligibility, and an established pattern of movement (p. 149; S3-S5).

Whittle has already explained the importance of this harvest exception. The further question here concerns its scope. A saving for seasonal movement is not worded as a general permission to terminate an existing engagement, negotiate any wage, or abandon the obligations just sworn. Nor is the named geography an explicitly closed list: the addition of other places and the reference to prior custom prevent a county-only lookup from resolving all cases. Positive evidence of a protected customary route and silence about a different locality are not equivalent evidence for exclusion.

Return deserves separate attention. The saving protects coming to labour elsewhere and safely returning. Its object is a circuit of seasonal labour, not simply an outward escape. This is a form of mobility compatible with a regulated labour supply. It would be equally reductive to treat the saving as general liberation or to dismiss it because wage and service constraints persisted. The particular freedom lay in preserving a movement that the surrounding restriction could otherwise obstruct.

The juxtaposition of 1349 departure and 1351 movement introduces a genuine interpretive boundary. Under a cumulative reading, a traveller can be clear of the seasonal restriction while still implicated by an unexpired term. The cited saving does not expressly resolve every interaction between those provisions. The code therefore reports both clause-level results; the combined result is explicitly labelled a cumulative reading. Establishing how actual authorities resolved a disputed overlap would require an appropriate case, rather than treating a software composition rule as a judicial precedent.

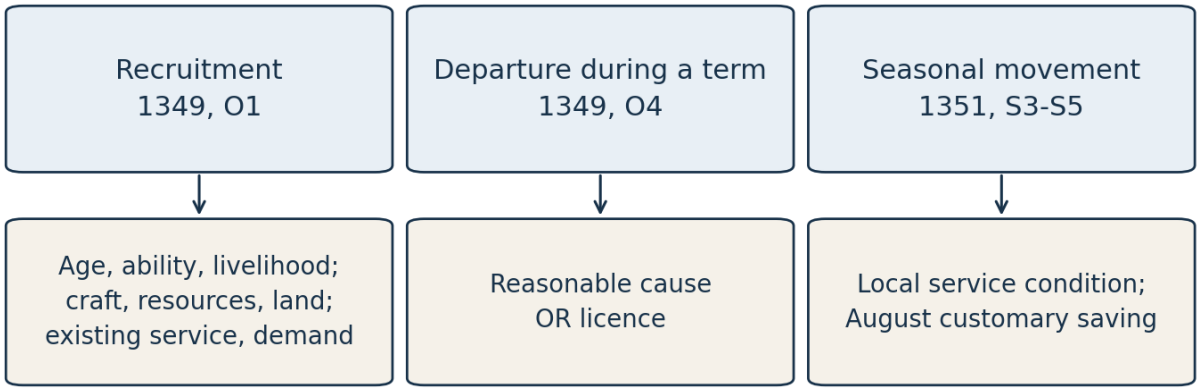


Figure 1. Three distinct objects of qualification. Sources: White and Notestein (1915), pp. 141-142, 149. Arrows connect a rule to its own qualifications, not stages of a universal career.

6. After intervention: surety, authority, and acquittal

The 1349 ordinance's response to a qualifying refusal proceeds through proof before designated local authorities and commitment to gaol. Its specified endpoint is surety to serve in the prescribed form. The body can leave detention through a commitment to the very service previously refused. Release is consequently part of the mechanism for making service obligatory, rather than evidence that the obligation has disappeared (White and Notestein 1915, p. 142; O3).

The 1351 passage combines fine and ransom, custody, surety, and future compliance. The formulation distinguishes an immediate custodial position from obligations concerning service, work, and sale. The text does not justify collapsing these into a single variable such as free or imprisoned. A change in custody is one legal event; the commitments attached to that change are another (pp. 151-152; S6).

The Derbyshire commission of 1356 makes a further distinction visible. It directs inquiry into officials who had arrested workers under colour of the ordinance and statute and then, by their own authority, freed them for fines and ransoms appropriated to their own use, without observing the statutory conditions. Putnam's Latin joins the privately directed receipts, the officials' own authority, and the nonobservance of conditions in the description of the conduct under inquiry (Putnam 1908, Appendix, pp. 24-25; White and Notestein 1915, p. 153; D1).

The commission does not condemn every release, every fine, or every settlement. Indeed, it also commissions adjudication of unfinished processes and reserves amercements and other things due to the king. Its concern is structured by authority, statutory observance, and fiscal destination. The words cannot safely be recruited as evidence of a humanitarian campaign against detention. They do show that the power to effect release was contested within the enforcement apparatus itself (White and Notestein 1915, pp. 153-154; D1-D2).

The distinction complicates the identification of freedom with royal grace or local discretion considered in isolation. The same outward event, a worker leaving official

custody, could be framed as the result of compliance, as an unauthorized exaction, or as a judicial disposition. Asking who could release a person and on what terms is therefore part of asking how a freedom was made. The commission gives evidence of the crown's stated concern and authorization to inquire; it does not tell us how many officials were convicted or how many such releases occurred.

Cornwall in 1358 supplies a different sequence. A presentment accuses named people of excessive wages, prices, and profits. Attachment is ordered for Friday at Penryn. Four defendants fail to appear: John Clegh junior, Nichola Karn, Dionisia Trethak, and Thomas Tremenhir. Their pledges are placed in mercy, and their arrest is ordered for Saturday at Helston. On Saturday the sheriff reports them arrested and in custody. They deny guilt and put themselves upon the country. The jury acquits these four of the presented excesses and trespasses; the record then directs that they depart quit. Other defendants are found guilty and make fine (Putnam 1908, Appendix, pp. 152-154; White and Notestein 1915, pp. 156-157; C1-C5).

Several inferences must be resisted. The four defendants were not simply acquitted on first appearance: the intervening process involved nonappearance, pledges, and custody. Their arrest also did not establish guilt: the acquittal follows it. Their eventual discharge is not recorded as release on surety to serve. Finally, the edited record does not explain why the jury acquitted them, supply their wider employment history, or identify their free or servile status. Those omissions delimit the argument. The record supports a sequence and a particular outcome, not an invented account of successful resistance or benevolent officials.

The occurrence of women among the four makes the individual naming worth preserving. It does not permit a gender comparison, because the excerpt is neither a complete population nor a controlled set of outcomes. Similarly, four acquittals cannot be divided by the abridged list of accused people to produce a defensible acquittal rate. The historical gain is different: a proceeding within a coercive system could include an accusation, a coercive bodily intervention, and a subsequent finding that discharged that accusation. Each has to remain visible.

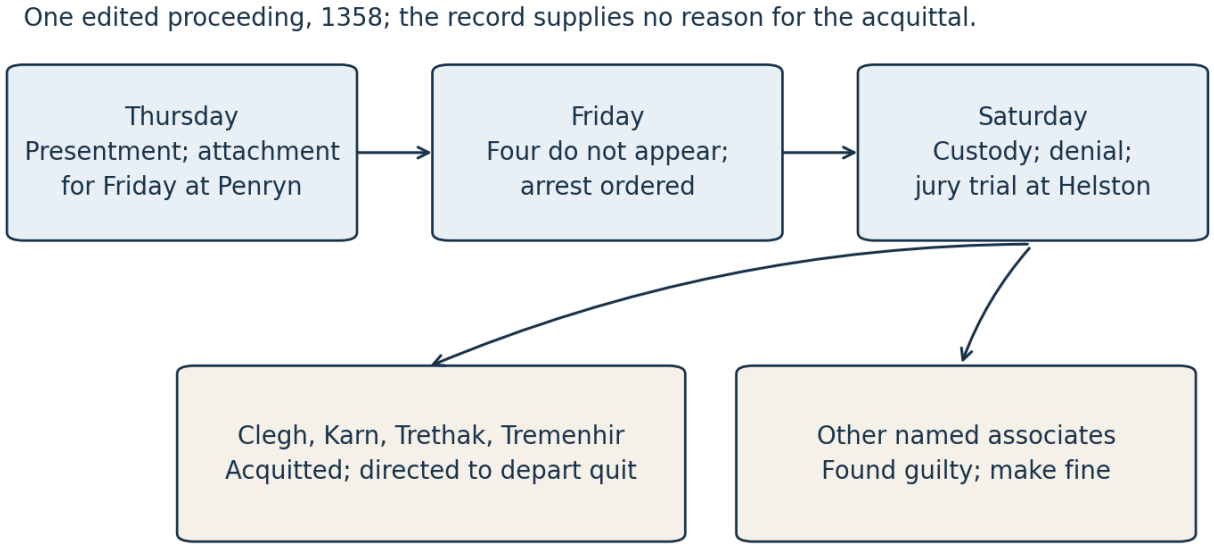


Figure 2. The Cornwall sequence, 1358. Source: Putnam (1908), Appendix, pp. 152-154; White and Notestein (1915), pp. 156-157. The branches are outcomes within one proceeding, not a population sample.

7. Executable reconstruction and sensitivity

The reconstruction uses separate functions for recruitment, early departure, seasonal movement, and the commission's stated concern. Let A indicate bodily ability, Y age below sixty, T livelihood by trade, C an exercised craft, P sufficient own resources, L occupation on one's own land, E existing service, and D a suitable demand. The recruitment trigger is represented as R = A AND Y AND NOT T AND NOT C AND NOT P AND NOT L AND NOT E AND D. These are interpreted predicates, not automatically extracted facts. Status is retained as metadata because the clause expressly includes free and bond people.

For early departure, let H indicate departure during an active agreed term, X recognized licence, and Q recognized reasonable cause. The trigger is B = H AND NOT (X OR Q). For an otherwise in-scope summer service departure, let V mean local service is available on the stipulated terms, G the August condition, and K eligibility for the protected customary movement. The seasonal restriction is M = V AND NOT (G AND K). Wage regulation is not removed by any result of M. A cumulative reading combines B and M with OR, while preserving the individual outputs.

The predicates deliberately retain judgment. The programme does not infer Q from a story of hardship, calculate an employer's necessary workforce, or decide K from a person's county alone. Unknown values follow a three-valued evaluation: a known decisive prohibition or failed condition may settle an output, but an otherwise decisive unknown remains unknown. This formal discipline is useful precisely because a binary label can make missing historical evidence look like a legal decision.

The finite checks enumerate 256 binary recruitment profiles for each of two status labels, eight departure profiles, twelve seasonal profiles including unknown customary eligibility, and sixty-four binary combinations of the two departure restrictions. These are logical assignments, not observations, people, or estimates of medieval behaviour.

Of the twelve seasonal assignments, one remains unresolved: available local service, August movement, and unknown protected custom. Where August is false or local service unavailable, customary uncertainty is not decisive for this particular rule.

Five of the sixty-four combined assignments are clear of the seasonal restriction but trigger the early-departure provision under the cumulative reading. This count has a purely logical meaning: it supplies counterexamples to the transfer of a seasonal exception into a general licence to leave. It is not a claim that five sixty-fourths of historical travellers broke their engagements. Changing a reader's assumptions about how the provisions interact may change the combined output; it cannot erase the fact that the texts address different acts.

The sensitivity analysis deliberately constructs five defective readings. One omits reasonable cause, one requires both cause and licence, and one omits the exceptions to early departure altogether. Two further readings replace the qualified movement rule with a blanket ban or omit its customary saving. Table 2 reports disagreements with the declared reconstruction over each eight-assignment binary domain. The small domains are exhaustive and unweighted; their counts are intelligible checks of semantic consequences rather than measures of how common an error is.

Table 2. Constructed reading mutations: disagreements with the declared reconstruction. Every domain contains eight equally enumerated logical assignments; none is a historical sample.

Mutation	Disagreements	Domain
Omit reasonable cause	1	8
Require cause AND licence	2	8
Omit both departure qualifications	3	8
Replace mobility rule with blanket ban	5	8
Omit customary August saving	1	8

Two state transformations clarify the release argument. In the surety transformation, custody ends and the service commitment is explicitly preserved. In the acquittal transformation, custody ends and the presented accusation is marked acquitted, while an unknown service obligation remains unknown. Neither transformation changes social status. These specifications give a precise sense to the historical proposition that release has an object: the state change is attached to a particular constraint, and other relations are updated only where the source warrants it.

Event / evidence	Custody	Service commitment	Accusation
Release on service surety O3 / S6	Ends	Preserved / secured	Not acquitted
Acquittal and discharge C4-C5	Ends	Not established by this disposition	Acquitted of presented charge
Official release under inquiry D1	Release alle	Not established by this commission	No verdict supplied

Equal changes in custody need not have equal effects on obligation or accusation.

Figure 3. Release has a limited object. Normative rules, a commission directive, and a reported disposition are compared; their evidential status differs. Unknown service relations are not filled by inference.

Nine automated regression tests cover the source-motivated distinctions, including the independent availability of cause and licence, the difference between craft exclusion and departure, unresolved custom, and the distinct effects of surety and acquittal. All twenty-two register anchors are checked against the pinned edition OCR. The results files retain each enumerated assignment so readers can inspect counterexamples rather than trust an aggregate. Reproduction uses local, deterministic Python scripts and the pinned public sources.

There is no claim of an independent empirical validation set. The tests check implementation fidelity and expose the consequences of explicit interpretive choices. They cannot show that a court adopted those choices, adjudicate a missing fact, or prove novelty. A successful execution is consequently a reproducibility result within a historical argument, not experimental proof of medieval social relations.

8. What the reconstruction changes

The documentary sequence supports three conclusions. First, formal status and an actionable freedom must be distinguished. The ordinance could address free and bond people together while reserving other distinctions among recruitment, craft, resources, and service. Second, removing a constraint was not a general operation. A seasonal saving, permission to depart, surety, and acquittal each altered a particular relation or process. Third, the authority and conditions of release were themselves objects of governance, as the commission's treatment of privately appropriated receipts makes explicit.

These conclusions refine rather than replace accounts of labour coercion. Particular openings do not establish a free labour market. At the same time, a model that retains only coercion cannot distinguish a person who may successfully answer an accusation from one against whom it is sustained. That distinction is not incidental to the experience or practice of freedom. The making of a freedom could consist in recognizing the limited reach of a demand, a claim, or an accusation, without recognizing a general immunity from future demands.

The analysis also identifies a practical application for digital legal and historical collections. A searchable edition could attach to each exception its action, temporal scope, authority, source passage, and unresolved predicates. A reader searching for freedom of movement would then see the local-service condition, the customary saving, and the separate issue of an existing term. A custody record could distinguish surety from acquittal rather than display one undifferentiated release label. The supplied register and code provide a small working example of that representation.

For archival publishers, historical research platforms, and educational collections, this representation offers a way to expose interpretive scope alongside searchable text. The demonstrated application is traceability: a reader can move from a conclusion to the relevant provision and inspect the assumptions that produced it. Evaluation with institutional users would be a separate stage of development.

9. Limits and conclusion

The source base is intentionally small and dependent on published editions. It does not establish national enforcement frequencies, workers' subjective understandings, the prevalence of successful excuses, or the practical accessibility of sureties. The Cornwall excerpt is selected and abridged; the commission expresses a directive rather than a completed investigation. The statutory wording does not resolve every interaction among provisions. The reconstruction is a transparent reading of these witnesses, not a complete legal expert system or a replacement for archival investigation.

Those limits leave a definite historical result. In this sequence, exemption from recruitment, justification of departure, protection of customary movement, release securing service, and discharge of an accusation have distinguishable objects and consequences. They cannot be exchanged without changing the account. The distinction is visible in the texts before it is formalized, and the executable work makes its consequences reproducible.

For the study of pre-modern freedoms, the implication is to follow an act of release beyond the immediate removal of a bodily or procedural constraint. What relation had been interrupted? Who had authority to end it? What promise, customary qualification, or accusation defined the endpoint? What remained binding afterward? In England's post-plague labour laws, answers to those questions disclose freedoms made within continuing dependencies. Their particularity is part of their historical substance.

Data And Code

The source register, public-domain edition OCR, checksums, reconstruction, exhaustive outputs, regression tests, figure scripts, and editable manuscript are available at https://github.com/shi1720/conditional-freedoms. The repository README states the commands and interpretive limits. Code is released under the MIT licence; source editions retain their own status and attribution. This article reports the analysis as reproduced on 16 October 2026.

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APPENDIX A. SOURCE REGISTER

ID / date	Printed-edition locator	Interpretation retained
O1 / 1349	White and Notestein 1915, p. 141	Status does not exempt a person from this recruitment clause.
O2 / 1349	White and Notestein 1915, p. 142	Preference for lords is expressly limited; necessity is not numerically defined.
O3 / 1349	White and Notestein 1915, p. 142	The stated custodial endpoint requires a service commitment.
O4 / 1349	White and Notestein 1915, p. 142	Cause and licence qualify early departure; their adjudication is not specified here.
O5 / 1349	White and Notestein 1915, p. 142	The receiving employer is also exposed to a penalty.
O6 / 1349	White and Notestein 1915, pp. 142-143	Recruitment, departure and wage limits have different objects.
O7 / 1349	White and Notestein 1915, pp. 143-144	The craft exclusion in recruitment is not a blanket exclusion from wage regulation.
O8 / 1349	White and Notestein 1915, p. 145	Almsgivers are addressed as a way of compelling labour.
O9 / 1349	White and Notestein 1915, p. 146	The episcopal letter uses ecclesiastical sanctions for stipendiary chaplains.
S1 / 1351	White and Notestein 1915, p. 148	The edition preserves a qualification to annual service.
S2 / 1351	White and Notestein 1915, p. 149	Compliance is renewed by an oath before local officers.
S3 / 1351	White and Notestein 1915, p. 149	The summer mobility restriction contains a local-service condition.
S4 / 1351	White and Notestein 1915, p. 149	The named origins do not constitute an explicitly closed list.
S5 / 1351	White and Notestein 1915, p. 149	The saving explicitly addresses a return leg as well as outward labour.
S6 / 1351	White and Notestein 1915, p. 151	Custody can secure future compliance; it is not a manumission formula.
D1 / 1356	White and Notestein 1915, p. 153; Putnam 1908, Appendix, p. 25	The commission singles out self-authorized release for privately appropriated receipts without statutory observance.
D2 / 1356	White and Notestein 1915, p. 154; Putnam 1908, Appendix, p. 25	The commission expressly reserves receipts due to the crown.
C1 / 1358	White and Notestein 1915, p. 156; Putnam 1908, Appendix, p. 152	A presentment accuses; it is not yet a verdict.
C2 / 1358	White and Notestein 1915, p. 156; Putnam 1908, Appendix, p. 153	Four named defendants do not appear on Friday; an arrest is ordered.

ID / date	Printed-edition locator	Interpretation retained
C3 / 1358	White and Notestein 1915, p. 157; Putnam 1908, Appendix, p. 154	Saturday custody is reported before the trial disposition.
C4 / 1358	White and Notestein 1915, p. 157; Putnam 1908, Appendix, p. 154	The jury acquits the four named defendants of the presented excesses and trespasses.
C5 / 1358	White and Notestein 1915, p. 157; Putnam 1908, Appendix, p. 154	Discharge follows this acquittal; a general employment exemption is not recorded.

APPENDIX B. REPRODUCIBILITY AND DECISION BOUNDARIES

Run python3 -m src.register, python3 -m src.analyze, and python3 -m unittest discover -s tests -v from the repository root. Figure generation and PDF production are separate commands documented in the README. The analysis and tests use only Python's standard library. The figure and document scripts require Matplotlib and ReportLab. The stored edition checksums allow the exact inputs used here to be distinguished from later OCR revisions.

The recruitment function does not model procedure after refusal. The seasonal function assumes that the person and contemplated act already fall within the relevant servant and summer-departure scope. Its local-service predicate includes the stipulated terms; it is not simply a vacancy indicator. Protected custom is supplied as an interpreted fact and is deliberately not determined from a fixed list of counties. Reasonable cause likewise means recognized cause for the provision, not an unassessed allegation. The combined-departure function implements a cumulative reading and preserves the component results for alternative interpretations.

The release functions reconstruct only the effects stated in their respective passages. The surety function is not applied to the Cornwall acquittal. The acquittal function does not assign a new employment or status fact. The commission function flags the conjunction singled out for inquiry rather than declaring the complement lawful. In particular, a false output from any trigger means that this trigger is absent, not that the person is generally free. These boundaries are part of the substantive interpretation, not merely software documentation.